

Aged Domain Acquisition Guide — STRASSER LAB

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Why Aged Domains Matter

Email gateways check domain age. A domain registered yesterday gets a high spam score before the email is even opened. A domain registered 3+ years ago passes the age check silently.

Domain Age	Spam Score Impact	Inbox Rate
0–30 days	Heavy penalty	30–50%
1–6 months	Moderate penalty	50–70%
6–12 months	Light penalty	70–85%
3+ years	No penalty	85–95%
5+ years	Trust bonus	90–98%

Best Sources

1. ExpiredDomains.net — Free Search (Start Here)

URL: <https://expireddomains.net>

This is the industry-standard free tool. 500,000+ expired and expiring domains, updated daily.

Filter setup:

TLD: .com, .net, .org, .cc
Age: 3+ years

Backlinks: 10 minimum
Price: \$0–\$200
Exclude: Adult, Gambling, Pharmacy, Casino
Sort by: Domain Age (oldest first)

How to evaluate a candidate: 1. Copy the domain name 2. Open <https://web.archive.org> — paste the domain 3. Check what the site USED to be. If it was a real business, blog, or local service — good. If it was a spam page or parked domain with ads — skip. 4. Run through <https://mxtoolbox.com/blacklists.aspx> — must show 0/100 blacklists 5. Check USPTO for trademarks: <https://www.uspto.gov/trademarks/search>

2. GoDaddy Auctions — Largest Inventory

URL: <https://auctions.godaddy.com>

65% of all expired domain sales happen here.

Filter for bargains:

Type: Closeout (fixed price, no bidding)
Price: Under \$50
Age: 2+ years
TLD: .com, .net, .cc

Closeout domains are \$12 + registration fee. They're domains nobody bid on during the auction phase. Most are garbage but 5–10% are hidden gems — small businesses that shut down, personal blogs that were abandoned, local services that went out of business. These have clean history at a bargain price.

3. NotRenewing.com — Flat \$99

URL: <https://notrenewing.com>

Launched March 2026. Every domain is \$99 fixed price. Minimum 24 months old, expiring within 12 months. Sellers list domains they plan to let expire anyway. Good for finding domains with 3–5 years of clean history at a predictable price.

4. NameJet / SnapNames — Backordering

URL: <https://namejet.com> | <https://snapnames.com>

Place a backorder on an expiring domain. If you're the only bidder, you get it at the reserve price (\$69). If multiple bidders, it goes to a 3-day private auction. Best for targeting domains you've already vetted on ExpiredDomains.net.

Step-by-Step Acquisition

Step 1: Hunt (5 minutes)

1. Open ExpiredDomains.net
2. Apply filters: .com/.net/.cc, age 3+, backlinks 10+, price under \$200
3. Open 20 candidates in tabs

Step 2: Vet (2 minutes per domain)

1. Web Archive check — was it a real site?
2. Blacklist check — is it clean?
3. Trademark check — is it safe to use?
4. Backlink check — are links from real sites or spam farms?

Step 3: Buy

1. GoDaddy Closeout: click “Buy Now” → checkout → domain in your account in minutes
2. NotRenewing: click “Buy” → pay \$99 → domain transferred within 24 hours
3. NameJet backorder: place bid → wait for domain to drop → if won, domain in account in 24 hours

Step 4: Transfer to Cloudflare

1. After purchase, unlock the domain at your registrar
 2. Get the transfer authorization code
 3. Cloudflare Dashboard → Add Site → Transfer Domain
 4. Enter the code → pay 1 year renewal → domain lives on Cloudflare
 5. Set up DNS + Worker (our standard deployment)
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Red Flags — Do NOT Buy

- **Parked with ads** — the domain was never a real site, just a landing page with ads. No backlink value, likely flagged.
 - **Pharmacy/casino/adult history** — even if clean now, these niches trigger spam filters permanently.
 - **Trademarked name** — using “microsoft-support.cc” gets you sued and your domain seized.
 - **Spam score above 5%** — Moz Spam Score or similar. Check before buying.
 - **Dropped multiple times** — WHOIS shows repeated creation dates. The domain was repeatedly abandoned.
 - **Chinese/Japanese characters in backlinks** — common sign of a spam network.
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Quick Reference

ExpiredDomains.net	– Free domain hunting (start here)
GoDaddy Auctions	– Closeout bargains (\$12+)
NotRenewing.com	– Flat \$99 aged domains
NameJet	– Backordering (pay only if you win)
web.archive.org	– Check what a domain used to be
mxttoolbox.com	– Blacklist check
uspto.gov	– Trademark search

Budget: \$50–\$150 gets you a solid aged domain

Stage	Cost
GoDaddy Closeout purchase	\$12–\$50
Transfer to Cloudflare	\$8–\$10 (1 year renewal)
Total	\$20–\$60

For \$150 you can get a 5+ year aged .com with clean history and 20+ backlinks. Worth every dollar for the inbox rate improvement.